

Website Maintenance Guide

This guide tells you how to update the website **nme.fas.harvard.edu**. You do not have to write code. There are 2 ways: a **form** for the most common changes, and **Claude Code** for everything else.

Website: **nme.fas.harvard.edu** Made by Christopher Ruaño Date: July 2026

Section 01

How the website works

The website files are on **GitHub**. GitHub keeps a record of each change. When a change is published, the website shows it in about 1 minute. There is no publish button and no server to log in to.

You have 2 ways to make a change:

- **A form (the easy way).** For the 4 most common changes, you fill in a form on GitHub. You do not need a terminal. Refer to Section 02.
- **Claude Code (for everything else).** Claude Code is an assistant on your computer. You tell it what to change in plain English. Refer to Section 03 and later.

◆ You cannot break the website permanently. GitHub keeps each change in its record. You can undo each change. Refer to Section 10.

Section 02

The easy way: use a form

For the most common changes, you do not need Claude Code or a terminal. You fill in a form on GitHub. The website prepares the change for you and opens a request. You look at the request and click one button to publish.

The forms cover these tasks

- Add a news item
- Add a lab member
- Remove a lab member
- Change text on a page

How to use a form

- 1 Go to the website page on GitHub: `github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website`.
- 2 Click the **Issues** tab. Then click the green **New issue** button.
- 3 Choose the form for your task. For example, **Add a news item**.
- 4 Fill in the fields. To add a photo, drag it into the Photo box. Then click **Submit new issue**.
- 5 Wait about 1 minute. The website adds a comment with a link to a **pull request**. A pull request is a change that waits for your approval.
- 6 Open the pull request. Look at the change.
- 7 Click the green **Merge pull request** button to publish. The website shows the change about 1 minute later.

! Nothing goes live until you click **Merge pull request**. If the change is not correct, do not merge it. Close the pull request, or ask Claude Code to help.

◆ The forms do only the 4 tasks above. For any other change (a publication, a slideshow image, the CV, and more), use Claude Code. The prompts are in Section 05.

Section 03

First-time setup for Claude Code

Do the steps in this section one time. After this, each change takes only a few minutes. You do not need this section for the forms in Section 02.

You need these items

- A **computer** (Mac or Windows).
- A **GitHub account**. You are an Admin of the website. An Admin has full control. The website files are at `github.com/christopherruano/carmody_lab_website`.
- **Claude Code**, installed on the computer. Chris or the IT team can install Claude Code. They can also sign you in. To start Claude Code, open the Terminal app, type `c laude`, and push the Enter key.

◆ Ask a person to do one change with you the first time. Then you see all the steps one time. After this, the steps are easy.

The folder for the website

The website files are in a folder on your computer. The person who helps you makes a shortcut to this folder. You do not open the files. You start Claude Code in this folder. Then you type your request.

Section 04

How to make a change with Claude Code

Each change has the same 3 steps:

- 1 **Tell Claude Code what to change.** Write in usual English. Give the names, the dates, and the exact words.
- 2 **Look at the result.** Ask Claude Code to show you the change. Read it.
- 3 **Publish the change.** Use the prompt below. The website shows the change in about 1 minute.

PROMPT TO PUBLISH

The change is good. Publish it to the website.

- ◆ You can make more than one change before you publish. Make all the changes. Look at the result. Then publish one time. If you do not see the change, refresh the page. On a Mac, push Cmd+Shift+R. On Windows, push Ctrl+F5.

Section 05

Prompts for each change

Find your task below. Copy the prompt. Fill in the parts in [brackets]. Paste it into Claude Code. Each prompt ends with "Show me the result." Read the result, then publish.

News

Add a news item

PROMPT

Add a news item. The date is [for example: July 15, 2026]. The text is: '[the news, in the exact words]'. Put it at the top of the correct year on the News page. Put it also at the top of the Recent News list on the home page. Keep the Recent News list to the 4 newest items. Add it to the site search. Show me the result.

Correct a news item

PROMPT

On the News page, find the item that says '[some words from the item]'. Change it to: '[the correct words]'. Change the same item on the home page and in the site search. Show me the result.

Remove a news item

PROMPT

Remove the news item that says '[some words from the item]' from the News page, the home page, and the site search. Show me the result.

People

Add a current member

PROMPT

Add a new current member to the People page. The name is [full name]. The role is [for example: Graduate Student]. The email is [the address, or 'none']. The bio is: '[the bio, or 'none']'. The photo is the file [file name] in the images/people folder. Add the member to the site search. Show me the result.

Change a member's role, email, or bio

PROMPT

On the People page, find [name]. Change the [role / email / bio] to: '[the new text]'. Update the site search also. Show me the result.

Change a member's photo

PROMPT

Change the photo for [name] on the People page. The new photo is the file [file name] in the images/people folder. Show me the result.

Move a member to the Former list

PROMPT

Move [name] from Current to Former Laboratory Members on the People page. The destination is: '[for example: Postdoctoral Fellow, Smith Lab, Yale University]'. Update the site search also. Show me the result.

Remove a member

PROMPT

Remove [name] from the People page and the site search. Show me the result.

Publications

Add a publication

PROMPT

Add a publication to the Publications page. Put it under [the year, or 'Preprints']. The authors are [the list. Make the lab members bold]. The title is: '[title]'. The journal is: '[journal, volume, pages, year]'. The link is [the DOI or the URL]. The PDF is the file [file name] in the pdfs folder, or there is no PDF. Add it to the site search. Show me the result.

Correct a publication

PROMPT

On the Publications page, find the publication with the title '[some words from the title]'. Change the [authors / title / journal / link] to: '[the correct text]'. Show me the result.

The CV

Replace the CV

Save the new CV with the name `Carmody_CV.pdf`. Put it in the `docs` folder. Replace the old file. Keep the same file name. Then use this prompt:

PROMPT

Replace the CV on the website with the new `Carmody_CV.pdf` in the docs folder. Then publish.

Home page and slideshow

Change the welcome text on the home page

PROMPT

On the home page, change the main welcome text to: '[the new text]'. Show me the result.

Change a slideshow caption

PROMPT

On the home-page slideshow, change the caption for slide [number]. The finding is: '[the new finding]'. The citation is: '[the new citation]'. Show me the result.

Replace a slideshow image

PROMPT

Replace the image for slide [number] in the home-page slideshow. The new image is the file [file name] in the images folder. Show me the result.

Other pages

Change text on the Research page or the Our Space page

PROMPT

On the [Research / Our Space] page, change the text '[the current words]' to '[the new words]'. Show me the result.

Change a contact email, a phone number, or the address

PROMPT

Change the [email / phone number / address] from '[the current value]' to '[the new value]'. Change it on the Contact page and in the footer at the bottom of each page. Show me the result.

Any page

Change any text

PROMPT

On the [page name] page, change the text '[the current words]' to '[the new words]'. Show me the result.

Change or correct a link

PROMPT

On the [page name] page, find the link '[the link words]'. Change its address to [the new URL]. Show me the result.

Section 06

Add a photo or a file

Some Claude Code changes need a file first: a photo or a PDF. There are 2 methods. (The forms in Section 02 handle the photo for you.)

- **Method 1 (more easy):** Tell Claude Code where the file is. Claude Code moves it. For example: *"There is a photo on my Desktop. The name is headshot.jpg. Add it as the photo for Jane Doe."*
- **Method 2 (manual):** Move the file into the correct folder yourself. Then tell Claude Code that the file is there.

FILE TYPE	PUT IT IN THIS FOLDER
images/people/	Photos of members (square, 600px or more)
pdfs/	PDFs of publications
docs/	The CV. Give it the name Carmody_CV.pdf
images/	Images for the home-page slideshow

Section 07

Get the best result from Claude Code

These rules help you get a good result each time:

- **Give the exact words.** Put the exact text in quotation marks. Claude Code uses the words that you give.
- **Change one thing at a time.** One clear request is better than a long list.
- **Look before you publish.** Say: *"Show me the result first."*
- **Correct it in plain words.** If the result is wrong, say what is wrong. For example: *"The date is wrong. Change it to May 3, 2026."*
- **You do not need technical words.** Describe what you see. For example: *"The photo of John looks stretched. Please make it look correct."*
- **To stop, say so.** Say: *"Do not publish. Undo that change."*

Section 08

Other tasks Claude Code can do

Claude Code can do more than the tasks above. Here are some examples.

Check the website for problems

PROMPT

Check the whole website. Find broken links, spelling mistakes, and images that do not load. Make a list of what you find. Do not change anything yet.

Get an explanation

PROMPT

In simple words, tell me what the [page or file name] does. Do not change anything.

See the recent changes

PROMPT

Show me a list of the changes to the website from the last month.

Ask a question

You can ask Claude Code a question in plain words. For example: *"How do I add a new page to the website?"* Claude Code answers the question. It can also do the task for you.

 **Codex.** Codex is a similar tool from OpenAI. It works the same way: you start it in the website folder, you type your request in plain English, and it edits the files. The prompts in this guide work with Claude Code and with Codex. Use the tool that Chris or the IT team sets up for you.

Section 09

The files of the website

You do not need this list to make a change. Claude Code knows the files. But the list can help you.

FILE	WHAT IT IS
index.html	Home page
about.html	About page
research.html	Research page
people.html	People page
publications.html	Publications page
laboratory.html	Our Space page
news.html	News page
contact.html	Contact page
js/main.js	Menu, footer, search box, slideshow
css/styles.css	Colors, fonts, spaces

! 2 facts are important. First, the menu and the footer are in the file `js/main.js`. They show on each page. Second, the site search has its own list. When you add a member, a publication, or a news item, Claude Code must update this list also. The prompts in Section 05 tell Claude Code to do this.

Section 10

Solve a problem

No change is permanent. GitHub keeps a record of each change. You can undo each change.

A change is wrong on the website

PROMPT

Undo the last change. Then publish the correction.

You want the website as it was before today

PROMPT

Change the website back to the version from before today. Then publish it.

The website does not change after 5 minutes

First, refresh the page. On a Mac, push `Cmd+Shift+R`. On Windows, push `Ctrl+F5`. If the website is still not correct, use this prompt:

PROMPT

Did my last change go to GitHub? Check it. If not, publish it.

A form did not work

The website adds a comment on your issue if there is a problem. Read the comment. Check the fields that you filled in. Then submit the form again, or ask Claude Code to make the change.

Claude Code is not clear, or you are not sure

PROMPT

Tell me in simple words what you will change. Do not publish yet.

◆ Do you have a problem that you cannot solve? Send an email to Christopher Ruaño at chris@linklane.ai. Or ask the IT team. GitHub keeps a record of each change. A good version is always available.